menler

Your turning point in the AI era.

SESSION 2 · COMPANION E-BOOK

THE POWER LAYER.

Stop Chatting with Claude, Start Working with Claude — where you stop guessing about AI and start operating it.

ONE LIVE SESSION
Skills, Connectors, Projects, Research & Creatives.

FOR EVERYONE
Written for total beginners and working professionals at once.

YOU LEAVE WITH
A connected Claude workspace that remembers and acts.

WELCOME TO SESSION 2

WEEKLY OBJECTIVE

You can drive Claude. Now you build the machine around it — Skills that shape it, Connectors that feed it your data, Projects that give it memory, and a research stack that outthinks any single tool.

Identity shift — Chatting with AI → Working with AI

THE TWO HALVES OF SESSION 2

FIRST HALF

SHAPE & FEED CLAUDE

Skills that change how Claude behaves, and Connectors that give it your real data — Drive, Gmail, Notion — so context beats prompting.

SECOND HALF

REMEMBER & OUTTHINK

Projects that hold persistent memory, a research pipeline across Perplexity + NotebookLM + Claude, and AI creatives across image, audio and video.

HOW EVERY TOPIC IS BUILT

This is your Session 2 companion — read it alongside the live class. It is written for two people at once: the total beginner who just met Claude, and the professional ready to build. Skim the plain-English parts; stop on the prompts and the build steps.

WHAT	A plain-English definition of the idea.
WHY	Why it matters to you as an operator.
WHERE	Where you actually meet it in Claude.
WHEN	When to reach for it — and when to ignore it.
HOW	How it works under the hood, still in plain words.

Every topic also carries: advantages and disadvantages, a real example, three professional prompts at three levels, step-by-step build-up and execution, and the odd Fun Fact.

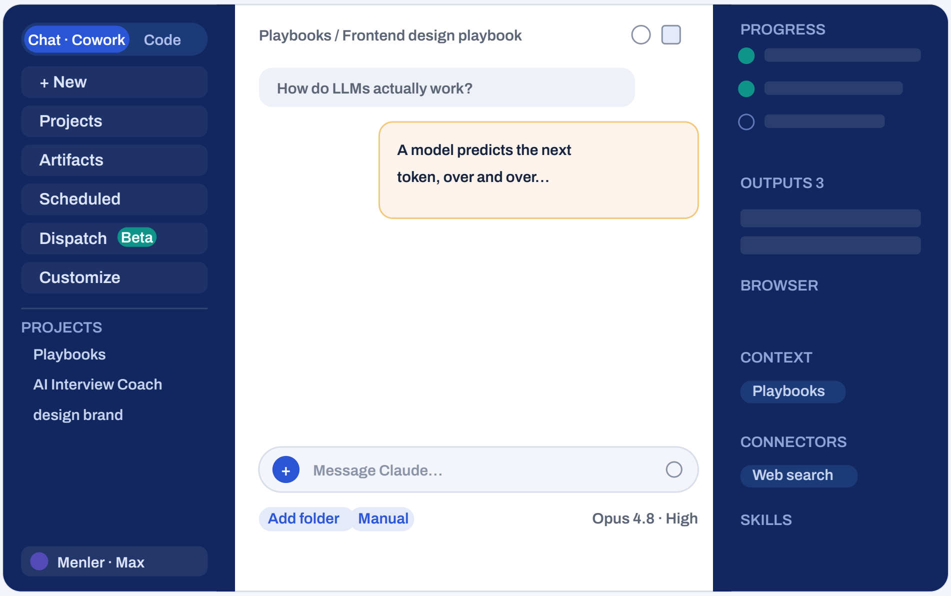
WHAT'S IN THIS SESSION

A full tour of the Claude app (3 pages), then a hands-on build guide, then the five topics of Session 2, then your session deliverable. Jump to whatever you need.

BEFORE YOU START · THE CLAUDE-FIRST TOUR

GETTING AROUND CLAUDE

This whole program runs on Claude. Learn the app once — here is the entire window, every part labelled.



THE CLAUDE APP — LEFT SIDEBAR, TOP BAR, CHAT (CENTRE), MESSAGE BOX (BOTTOM), AND THE LIVE PANEL (RIGHT)

THE LEFT SIDEBAR — WHERE YOU MOVE BETWEEN KINDS OF WORK

New — Start a fresh chat or Cowork session. Nothing carries over unless the session shares a Project.

Projects — Your Projects — shared folders of chats, files and instructions that persist across sessions and your team.

Artifacts — Your gallery of built pages and docs (dashboards, mini-apps, reports) that live on beyond the chat and can be re-opened or shared.

Scheduled — Tasks that run on a schedule — hourly, daily, weekly. View, pause, edit or run them here.

Dispatch — Hand a job to a background agent that plans and runs it while you do other things. (Beta.)

Customize — Your home for connectors, custom instructions, styles and preferences — set once, applies everywhere.

Projects list — Your projects pinned for quick access; click one to jump straight into its space.

Account · plan — Bottom-left: who you are and your plan (e.g. Max). The download icon gets the desktop app.

THE TOP BAR — WHERE YOU ARE, AND HOW TO GET AROUND

Chat · Cowork / Code — The mode switch. "Chat & Cowork" for everyday work with files and tools; "Code" opens Claude Code, the developer surface.

Search — Find any past chat, project or output by keyword.

Back / forward — Move through screens you have visited, like a browser.

Breadcrumb — Shows where you are (e.g. Playbooks / Frontend design...). Click a crumb to go up a level.

Panel & theme — Top-right icons: show or hide the side panels and switch light / dark.

THE MESSAGE BOX — HOW YOU BRIEF CLAUDE AND CONTROL IT

The "+" — Add connectors, upload files, and switch on skills for this message.

Add folder — Give the session a folder from your computer to read and write — pick the smallest folder that holds what is needed.

Approval: Manual / Auto / Skip — When Claude asks before acting. Manual = approve every action; Auto = auto-approves reads, checks writes; Skip = no prompts (trusted work only).

Dictate — The mic — talk instead of type.

Model · reasoning — Pick the model (e.g. Opus 4.8) and the thinking effort — High for hard problems, lower for speed.

THE PANEL ON THE RIGHT — WHAT CLAUDE SHOWS YOU WHILE IT WORKS

Progress — The live task list — every step Claude is taking, ticking off as it goes.

Outputs — The finished files from this session — open, preview, download, or send some to Drive.

Browser · Claude in Chrome — The browser Claude is driving for web tasks, when a browser is connected.

Context — What this session can see — the connected Project and folders (e.g. Playbooks).

Connectors — The apps switched on for this session (e.g. Web search); add more from "+" or Customize.

Skills — The packaged know-how Claude can apply here on demand.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

`Message box → Manual / Auto / Skip`

Set the approval mode before a big task. New to Cowork? Start on **Manual** so you approve each action. As you trust a routine, move to **Auto**. Keep **Skip** for small, contained jobs only.

THE THREE THINGS THAT TURN CLAUDE FROM A CHATBOT INTO A WORKSPACE

Anyone can type into Claude. The step up is **connecting your own apps**, **putting work on repeat**, and **handing off jobs to the background**. Here is where each lives and how to switch it on.

1

CONNECT YOUR APPS

CONNECTORS

A connector plugs one of your apps — Gmail, Google Drive, Notion, Slack, and hundreds more — straight into Claude, so it can read and act on that data instead of you copy-pasting.

1. Open Settings → Connectors (or, in a chat, click "+" → Connectors → Manage connectors).
2. Click the "+" next to Connectors to open the directory, then pick the app you want.
3. Click Connect, then sign in and approve access in the pop-up (this is OAuth — you approve, Claude never sees your password).
4. Back in any chat, click "+" → Connectors and toggle the app on for that conversation.

Free, Pro, Max, Team & Enterprise. Team/Enterprise: an Owner enables a connector for the org first. Choose the least access that does the job.

2

PUT WORK ON REPEAT

SCHEDULED TASKS

A scheduled task is a prompt Claude runs on its own on a set cadence — a Monday digest, a daily inbox triage — and reports back with no nudge from you.

1. In the left sidebar, click Scheduled.
2. Click New task → Create with Claude (guided) or Set up manually.
3. Write the prompt as a full standalone instruction, pick the cadence (hourly / daily / weekly / weekdays), and set the approval mode + folder.
4. Click Schedule. Pause, edit, or run it on demand any time from the same page.

Pro, Max, Team & Enterprise. Desktop for all paid plans; web & mobile in beta.

3

HAND OFF, WALK AWAY

DISPATCH

Dispatch is a background agent. You describe an outcome once; it breaks the job into tasks, runs each on its own, and surfaces the results later — even from your phone.

1. In the left sidebar, select Dispatch.
2. Describe the outcome like you would brief a colleague, in one message.
3. Let it plan — it starts child tasks that each show a status (Running, Awaiting input, Completed...).
4. Check back later: open any task to read the transcript and grab the files it produced.

Pro & Max, on the latest Claude Desktop (macOS/Windows). Keep the desktop app open to assign from mobile.

HANDS-ON · THE EXACT CLICKS

BUILD A SKILL

Write it once as a SKILL.md, save it into Claude, reuse it forever.

1 · WRITE THE SKILL.MD — A FOLDER WITH ONE FILE

SKILL.MD — FRONTMATTER = THE TRIGGER · BODY = THE RULES

```
---
name: meeting-notes
description: Turns a raw transcript into Menler-style
  notes. Call with /meeting-notes.
---

Rule 1 — one H2 heading per topic discussed.
Rule 2 — put each owner's name in bold.
Rule 3 — list every decision as a checklist.
Rule 4 — bullets under 15 words; no preamble.
Rule 5 — never invent action items not in the text.
```

name + description — the frontmatter. The **name** is how you call it — **/meeting-notes**; the description tells Claude what it does.

the body — 5–8 concrete rules Claude follows once it fires — testable, not vague.

2 · SAVE IT INTO CLAUDE

2

PUT IT INTO CLAUDE

SAVE THE SKILL

1. Record (Pro/Max/Team, Mac Cowork): “+” → Record a skill → do the task once → review → Save.
2. Or build it by hand: put SKILL.md in a folder and ZIP it — the skill folder as the root, not nested.
3. Go to Customize → Skills → Add / Upload and choose the ZIP.
4. Enable it under Customize → Skills, then test with a prompt that should trigger it.

Free, Pro, Max, Team & Enterprise. Needs code execution enabled. “Record a skill” is Pro/Max/Team on Mac.

3 · UPDATE A SKILL WHEN YOUR NEEDS CHANGE

3

CHANGE IT LATER

UPDATE THE SKILL

1. Quick edits: open the skill file as an artifact in a chat and use “Edit with Claude”.
2. Recorded skills: re-record the task — Claude offers Update instead of creating a new one.
3. Manual skills: edit SKILL.md, re-ZIP the folder, and re-upload via Customize → Skills.
4. If you changed WHEN it should fire, update the description — that line is the trigger.

Changes apply the next time the skill runs — no need to rebuild the Project it is attached to.

4 · CONNECT A CONNECTOR — GIVE CLAUDE YOUR DATA

4

FEED CLAUDE YOUR DATA

CONNECT A CONNECTOR

1. Open Customize → Connectors (or, in a chat, “+” → Connectors → Manage).
2. Click the “+” to open the directory and pick the app (Drive, Gmail, Notion, Slack...).
3. Click Connect, then sign in and approve in the OAuth pop-up — Claude never sees your password.
4. In any chat, “+” → Connectors → toggle it on; grant the least access that does the job.

Free (one), Pro, Max, Team & Enterprise. Team/Enterprise: an Owner enables it for the org first. Revoke any time.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

`Sidebar → Projects`

Best together, inside a Project. A **Skill** shapes the output, a **Connector** feeds it your real data, and a **Project** holds both with a system prompt. That trio is exactly the Connected Claude Workspace you build on p.26.

HANDS-ON · CALL IT ON DEMAND

RUN YOUR SKILL

A skill fires when you call it — type / in the message box and pick it.

YOUR SKILLS — TYPE / TO CALL ONE

/meeting-notes	format a transcript into clean notes	↵
/cold-email	draft outreach in your voice	
/research-brief	summarise sources into a brief	
/study-summary	turn notes into a revision sheet	

\+ /meeting-notes | paste your transcript…

TYPE "/" IN THE MESSAGE BOX → YOUR SKILLS APPEAR → PICK ONE → ADD YOUR INPUT

/

CALL IT ON DEMAND

TYPE / TO RUN A SKILL

1 In the message box, type / — every skill you have shows up in a menu.

2 Pick one, or keep typing its name, e.g. **/meeting-notes**.

3 Add your input right after it — paste the text, attach the file — and send.

4 Attach the skill to a **Project** so it is ready in every chat there.

The **name** in your SKILL.md is the slash command, so keep it short and kebab-case (e.g. **/cold-email**). A clear description also lets Claude reach for it on its own — but typing / runs it every time.

HANDS-ON · SEE IT WORK

IN ACTION

Two real examples — the /meeting-notes skill called with a slash, and a Gmail connector task.

A SKILL EXAMPLE — THE "MEETING NOTES" SKILL

YOU TYPE

```
/meeting-notes

so um we talked about the q3 launch, priya said
design is running late, ravi will chase the vendor
by friday, and we agreed to push the date to the
20th. also nisha to redo the deck.
```

CLAUDE · SKILL ON

Q3 LAUNCH

- **Priya** — design running late
- ☐ **Ravi** — chase vendor by Fri
- ☐ **Nisha** — redo the deck
- **Decision:** push launch to the 20th

A CONNECTOR EXAMPLE — GMAIL CONNECTED

YOU ASK

```
Summarise my last 5 emails from Ravi and flag
anything urgent. Keep it to bullets.
```

CLAUDE RETURNS

- 3 threads on the vendor delay — Ravi needs your sign-off
- ⚠ **Urgent:** contract expires Fri — reply today
- 2 FYI updates, no action needed

◆ **FIND IT IN CLAUDE** p.26 · your deliverable

This is what you are building. Your Meeting Notes skill + a connected inbox + a system prompt, all in one **Project** — that is the Connected Claude Workspace, and it is portfolio asset #2.

2.1 SESSION 2

CLAUDE SKILLS

Custom instruction sets that change how Claude behaves — write once, apply everywhere.

WHAT

A **Skill** is a reusable set of rules that change how Claude responds — **format** rules, **tone** rules, **domain** rules, and **output-structure** rules. There are built-in skills, and skills you define yourself. Stack several inside a Project and they combine.

WHY

Without a skill you re-explain *how* you want the output every single time. With one, Claude formats and styles it your way automatically — consistent output, zero repetition. It is the difference between instructing a temp and training a specialist.

WHERE

Turn a skill on from the **"+"** in the message box for one chat, or attach it to a **Project** so it always applies. In a Project, multiple skills interact.

WHEN

Build a skill for any output type you produce often — meeting notes, research briefs, cold emails, code comments, study summaries. One-off asks do not need one.

HOW IT WORKS

You write 5–8 clear rules (e.g. "always output as a Notion-ready doc", "actionable bullets only, no preamble"). Claude applies them on top of whatever you ask. When skills stack in a Project, more specific rules win, so keep them from contradicting each other.

ADVANTAGES

- + Consistent output without re-explaining every time
- + Reusable and shareable across your whole team
- + Stack them in a Project for a specialised assistant

DISADVANTAGES

- − Vague rules produce vague, inconsistent results
- − Too many stacked skills can conflict
- − A skill locks in a format — loosen it for creative work

EXAMPLE

A "Meeting Notes" skill with rules like "H2 per topic, owner in bold, decisions as a checklist, no filler" turns a messy transcript into the same clean format every time — no prompt needed beyond "notes from this."

★

Fun Fact

A good Skill is closer to an SOP than a prompt. The best operators do not have better prompts — they have a library of skills that make Claude behave the same way every time, like staff who already know the house style.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

`Message box → "+" → Skills`

Turn on a skill for this chat. Open the **"+"** menu and switch a **Skill** on for the conversation, or attach it to a Project so it always applies. The exact clicks to write, save and update a skill are on p.7.

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER — FILL THE ORANGE

```
I always produce meeting notes. Write me a simple Claude
Skill: 5 rules that define exactly how the output should be
formatted and styled. Plain language.
```

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE — FILL THE ORANGE

```
Act as a prompt engineer. Turn my messy style preferences
paste them into a clean 6-rule Skill instruction set for
output type, covering format, tone, structure and what to
never do.
```

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL — FILL THE ORANGE

```
Act as my Claude architect. Design a set of 3 stacking Skills
for my role — one for format, one for tone, one for domain
rules — that work together without conflicting inside a Project.
Give the rules for each and a note on their order of priority.
```

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

1. Pick one output type you produce often (notes, briefs, emails).
2. Write 5–8 rules that define exactly how Claude should format and style it.
3. Test it: run a raw input with the skill on; screenshot before vs after.
4. Refine across 3 different inputs until the output is consistent.

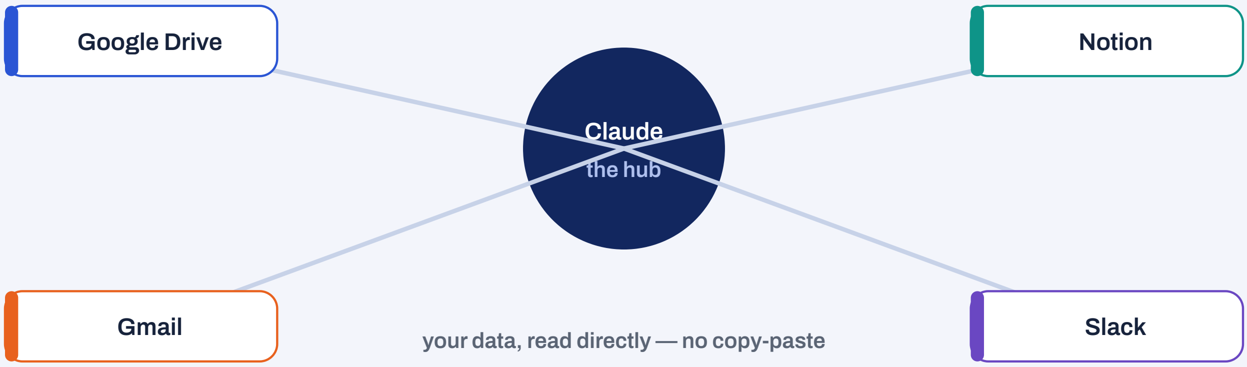
EXECUTE IT

1. Keep each rule concrete and testable — “bullets under 15 words”, not “be concise”.
2. Name what to NEVER do — that removes most bad outputs.
3. Add the finished skill to your Claude Project so it always applies.
4. Share the skill + 2 before/after screenshots in Discord.

2.2 SESSION 2

CLAUDE CONNECTORS

Native integrations that give Claude your data — context beats prompting alone.



WHAT

A **Connector** plugs one of your existing tools straight into Claude — **Google Drive**, **Gmail**, **Notion**, and hundreds more — so Claude can read (and sometimes act on) that data directly, no copy-paste. You control exactly what it can access.

WHY

Most people try to make Claude smarter with better prompts. The bigger lever is **context**: give the same model your real files, emails and notes and the output jumps in quality, because it is working from your world, not guesses.

WHERE

Connect them once under **Customize → Connectors** (or the **"+"** → Connectors → Manage), then toggle each one on per chat from the **"+"**.

WHEN

Reach for a connector whenever a task needs your own data — summarise a thread, pull action items from a doc, find themes across your notes. For general questions, no connector is needed.

HOW IT WORKS

You sign in and approve access in a pop-up — this is **OAuth**: you grant scoped permission, Claude never sees your password. It gets the least access you allow. A connector suits reading and light actions; a full **API** build is for heavy, custom automation.

ADVANTAGES

- + Context beats prompting — dramatically better output
- + No more copy-pasting from your tools
- + You control the scope and can revoke any time

DISADVANTAGES

- – Setup and permissions to think through first
- – Only as good as how tidy your source data is
- – Team/Enterprise need an owner to enable them first

EXAMPLE

"Summarise my last 5 emails from [contact]" or "list the action items from my Q3 planning doc" — with Gmail or Drive connected, Claude reads the source itself. A 15-minute manual task becomes 15 seconds.

★

Fun Fact

The phrase to remember is "context beats prompting". A mediocre prompt with your real data connected usually beats a brilliant prompt working blind — because the model is no longer guessing what your world looks like.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

`Customize → Connectors`

Connect a tool, then reach it from "+". Connect Drive, Gmail or Notion once under **Customize → Connectors**, approve the OAuth pop-up, then toggle it on per chat from the **"+"**. Full connect steps are on p.8.

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER — FILL THE ORANGE

```
I connected Google Drive. Give me 5 simple tasks I can ask
you to do with it that would normally mean copy-pasting, and
the exact prompt for each.
```

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE — FILL THE ORANGE

```
With my Gmail connected, draft me a reusable prompt that
summarises my unread emails from this week, flags the 3 most
urgent, and drafts a one-line reply to each.
```

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL — FILL THE ORANGE

```
Act as a workflow designer. For my role with Drive, Gmail
and Notion connected, design 3 connector-powered tasks I should
run weekly, the prompt for each, and the least data access each
one needs. Output as a table.
```

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

1. Connect Claude to one tool you already use (Drive, Gmail, or Notion).
2. Give it a task that requires reading from that source — no manual paste.
3. Try: “summarise my last 5 emails from X” or “action items from my planning doc”.
4. Document the task, the prompt, and the output.

EXECUTE IT

1. Grant the least access that does the job; review permissions before approving.
2. Keep your source data tidy — clean docs and labels make far better output.
3. Note the time saved: “before connectors this took __ min; now __.”
4. Post one screenshot + your time comparison to Discord.

2.3 SESSION 2

CLAUDE PROJECTS

System prompt + skills + knowledge + connectors = a persistent intelligence system.

SYSTEM PROMPT
persona · context · constraints · output rules

SKILLS
format · tone · domain rules

KNOWLEDGE DOCS
your notes, SOPs, company context

CONNECTORS
live data from your tools

stacked together = a persistent intelligence system

WHAT

A **Project** is Claude with standing context. It holds a **system prompt** (who Claude is here, and the rules), your **Skills**, uploaded **knowledge documents**, and **connector** access — all shared across every chat inside it. Session memory that does not reset.

WHY

Plain conversations forget everything the moment they end. A Project remembers your persona, your rules and your knowledge, so you stop re-briefing Claude — and it becomes the foundation everything in Sessions 3 and 4 is built on.

WHERE

In the left sidebar under **Projects**. Create one per role, domain, or workflow; open it and every chat inside inherits its context.

WHEN

Spin up a Project for any ongoing area of work — a role, a client, a course, a research theme. Keep quick, unrelated questions in a normal chat.

HOW IT WORKS

The system prompt sets persona + context + constraints + output rules. Knowledge docs (your CV, SOPs, company context) give it facts to draw on. Skills shape the format. Connectors feed live data. Together they turn a generic model into “my senior analyst who already knows my domain.”

ADVANTAGES

+ Stop re-briefing — context is always loaded
+ One specialised assistant per role or domain
+ The base layer for automation in later sessions

DISADVANTAGES

− A weak system prompt gives a weak Project
− Stale knowledge docs quietly mislead — keep them fresh
− Too many overlapping Projects fragments your context

EXAMPLE

A “Content Marketing” Project: system prompt = “you are my content strategist”, a brand-voice Skill, your style guide uploaded, and the Notion connector on. Every chat inside already knows your voice, your rules, and your calendar.

★

Fun Fact

The system prompt is the highest-leverage paragraph you will write all week. A Project with a sharp 150-word system prompt out-performs hours of clever one-off prompting — because you set the rules once and they apply forever.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

`Sidebar → Projects → New project`

Build the Project in the sidebar. Create the Project under **Projects**, paste your system prompt into its instructions, attach your Skill, upload a knowledge doc, and enable a Connector — everything inside then inherits it.

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER

FILL THE ORANGE

```
Help me write a simple system prompt for a Claude Project
about my role. Cover: who you are here, what you should
assume about my work, and how to format answers. Keep it clear.
```

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE

FILL THE ORANGE

```
Write me a 150-word Project system prompt for my use case
that defines: your persona, the domain knowledge to assume, the
default output format, and 3 things you must never do.
```

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL

FILL THE ORANGE

```
Act as my Claude architect. Design a full Project for my role:
the system prompt, which Skills to attach, what knowledge
documents to upload, which Connectors to enable, and 3 example
tasks it should handle end-to-end. Output as a setup checklist.
```

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

1. Create a Claude Project named after your role or main use case.
2. Write a 150+ word system prompt: persona, domain, output format, and what to never do.
3. Attach a Skill (from 2.1) and upload one knowledge document.
4. Connect one Connector (from 2.2).

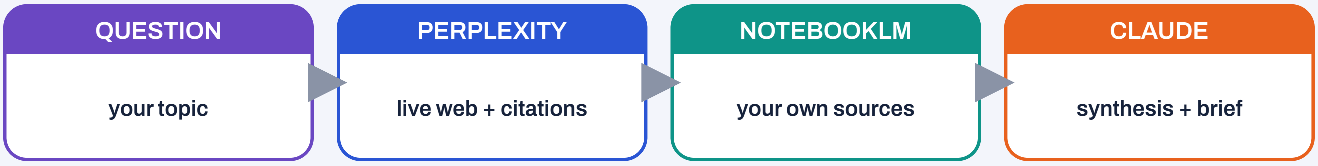
EXECUTE IT

1. Run 3 real tasks through the Project without switching tabs or pasting.
2. Tighten the system prompt wherever the output drifts from what you wanted.
3. Refresh knowledge docs as your context changes — stale docs mislead.
4. Save a Project Setup Summary as a Claude Artifact — portfolio asset #2.

2.4 SESSION 2

RESEARCH INTELLIGENCE

Question → Perplexity → NotebookLM → Claude — one tool is never enough.



one tool is never enough — chain them, then add your judgement

---

WHAT

Serious research uses a **stack**, not one tool. **Perplexity** does real-time web research with citations. **NotebookLM** lets you upload your own sources and interrogate them. **Claude** is the synthesis layer that fuses both into an insight brief.

WHY

Each tool has a blind spot: Claude alone can be out of date, Perplexity is thin on *your* private sources, NotebookLM cannot see the live web. Chained, they cover each other — and you get a sourced brief in under 30 minutes.

WHERE

Three tabs, one flow: Perplexity for the current picture, NotebookLM for your documents, and Claude (ideally in a Project) to synthesise and write the output.

WHEN

Use the full stack for any decision or deliverable that must be current *and* grounded in your own material. For a quick fact, one tool is enough.

HOW IT WORKS

The pipeline is **Question** → **Perplexity** (current data + citations) → **NotebookLM** (extracts from your sources) → **Claude** (synthesis + output). At the end you cross-reference, spot gaps, and add the human judgement AI cannot.

ADVANTAGES

+ Current AND grounded in your own sources
+ Every claim carries a citation trail
+ A 30-minute brief that used to take a day

DISADVANTAGES

- Three tools to learn and keep in sync
- Garbage sources in NotebookLM = garbage out
- Still needs your judgement on what is missing

EXAMPLE

Deciding on a market? Perplexity for the latest numbers and news, NotebookLM to interrogate two reports you own, then Claude to synthesise a 300-word brief with three recommendations and a source trail.

★

Fun Fact

NotebookLM will only answer from the sources you give it — which is exactly why researchers love it. It cannot "make things up" from the open web, so its answers stay anchored to documents you actually trust.

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER

FILL THE ORANGE

```
I have research findings from Perplexity and notes from my own
documents. Combine them into a simple 200-word summary with 3
key takeaways, in plain language.
```

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE

FILL THE ORANGE

```
Here are my Perplexity findings paste and my NotebookLM
extracts paste. Synthesise a 300-word insight brief on topic
with 3 recommendations, and flag anything the two sources
disagree on.
```

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL

FILL THE ORANGE

```
Act as a research analyst. From these live findings paste and
my source extracts paste, build a decision brief for [my
decision]: summary, 3 options with trade-offs, a recommendation,
the confidence level, and what evidence is still missing.
```

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

1. Pick a topic tied to a real decision you are making.
2. Perplexity: run 3 queries; capture the top results with citations.
3. NotebookLM: upload 2 documents you own and ask 5 questions.
4. Claude: paste both, ask for a 300-word brief with 3 recommendations.

EXECUTE IT

1. Cross-reference Perplexity and your own sources — note where they clash.
2. Ask Claude what is *missing*, not just to summarise what is there.
3. Keep the citation trail attached to the brief so it is checkable.
4. Save a 1-page Research Brief as a Claude Artifact and share it.

2.5 SESSION 2

AI CREATIVES

Image, audio, video — describe the intent, let Claude write the prompt, feed the tool.

MODALITY	TOOLS TO START WITH	USE IT FOR
Image	Midjourney · DALL·E 3 · Firefly · Ideogram	Social visuals, mockups, thumbnails
Audio	ElevenLabs (voice, TTS)	Narration, podcast intros, voiceover
Video	Runway · Sora · Pictory	Short clips, text-to-video explainers
In-tool	Canva AI · Adobe Firefly	Generate right inside your design app

The operator move: describe your intent to **Claude**, let it write the detailed prompt, then feed that to the image, audio or video tool.

WHAT

Generative creative AI spans three modalities. **Image** tools (Midjourney, DALL·E 3, Firefly, Ideogram) use diffusion. **Audio** tools (ElevenLabs) clone voices and turn scripts into narration. **Video** tools (Runway, Sora, Pictory) turn prompts or scripts into short clips. Claude is the brain that writes the prompts.

WHY

One person can now produce a whole creative set — visual, voiceover, and clip — that used to need a small team. The bottleneck is no longer skill with the tools; it is knowing how to **direct** them.

WHERE

Across dedicated tools, and increasingly inside apps you already use — Canva AI and Adobe Firefly generate images right where you design.

WHEN

Reach for a creative tool when you need an original asset — a social visual, a podcast intro, a product mockup, an explainer. Skip it when accuracy of text or data matters more than the look.

HOW IT WORKS

Image and video models start from noise and **denoise** toward your words (diffusion). The quality lives in the prompt — subject, style, lighting, composition, aspect ratio. The operator move: describe your intent to Claude, have it write the detailed prompt, then feed that to the image or video tool.

ADVANTAGES

+ A full creative set from one person
+ Endless variations from one idea
+ Style, mood and composition are all directable

DISADVANTAGES

− Same prompt ≠ same result — randomness by design
− Weak on exact text, counting and anatomy
− Copyright and ownership need care in professional use

EXAMPLE

A social launch: Claude writes an image prompt → Midjourney renders the visual, Claude writes a 30-second script → ElevenLabs voices it, then Canva AI assembles both into a shareable card. Four tools, one operator, one afternoon.

★

Fun Fact

The biggest shift is not the tools — it is the role. You stop being the maker and become the director: your taste and your brief are the scarce skill now, not your hands.

THE VISUAL-PROMPT FRAMEWORK — 8 PARTS OF A PROPER IMAGE / VIDEO PROMPT

1 Subject
The single main focus — who or what.
e.g. a founder holding a phone

2 Object
Key props / secondary items it interacts with.
e.g. a glowing app screen

3 Environment
Setting, background and location.
e.g. minimal studio, soft gradient

4 Situation
What is happening — the action or moment.
e.g. mid-launch, confident smile

5 Reference
Style anchor: medium, era, genre, film look.
e.g. premium tech-brand photography

6 Colour style
Palette, temperature, contrast.
e.g. navy + warm orange, high contrast

7 Motion style
Camera + subject movement (“still” for images).
e.g. slow push-in, subtle screen glow

8 Geometry style
Composition, lens, angle, framing, aspect ratio.
e.g. 50mm, eye-level, centered, 4:5

FILLED EXAMPLES — BUILD EVERY VISUAL THE SAME WAY

STILL · SOCIAL VISUAL — KEEP THE LABELS, SWAP THE ORANGE

```
Subject: your product held in one hand. Object: soft props that signal use case. Environment: clean studio / real setting. Situation: the key moment of use. Reference: premium brand product photography. Colour style: 2-colour palette, high contrast, soft shadow. Motion style: still. Geometry: 50mm, top-down, centered, 4:5.
```

MOTION · PODCAST/REEL INTRO — KEEP THE LABELS, SWAP THE ORANGE

```
Subject: host / logo mark. Object: mic / waveform. Environment: studio + time of day. Situation: the 3-second opening beat. Reference: show title-sequence look. Colour style: graded palette, cinematic contrast. Motion style: slow push-in + waveform pulse, 24fps. Geometry: 16:9, low angle, leading lines.
```

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

1. Pick a real brief: a social post, a podcast intro, a banner, or a short explainer.
2. Fill the 8 parts above, then have Claude expand them into a full image prompt.
3. Run it in Midjourney or DALL·E 3; iterate at least 3 times and save the best.
4. Have Claude write a 30-second script; voice it in ElevenLabs.

EXECUTE IT

1. Change ONE part at a time (light, then angle) to steer results.
2. For exact words on the image, put them in “quotes” inside Object.
3. Assemble image + audio in Canva AI or Gamma into one shareable asset.
4. Note where AI delivered and where it needed your creative direction.

YOUR WEEK 1 DELIVERABLE

CONNECTED CLAUDE WORKSPACE

The one thing to build this session — it feeds straight into Session 2.

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER — GENERATE & DROP IN

A hero image for your workspace summary cover

STRUCTURED PROMPT FOR CHATGPT / GEMINI / FIREFLY

SUBJECT	a central glowing "Claude Project" core	OBJECT	four labelled modules orbiting it — System Prompt, Skills, Knowledge, Connectors
ENVIRONMENT	deep-navy backdrop, soft grid, empty space along the top for a title	SITUATION	the four modules docked into the core, quietly "powered on"
REFERENCE	clean flat-vector infographic, modern tech-brand illustration	COLOUR STYLE	deep navy base, warm orange accents, small teal & purple highlights, high contrast
MOTION STYLE	still (for a video cover: modules slide in and dock one by one)	GEOMETRY STYLE	central core with four docked modules, generous negative space at top, minimal, 3:2

BRIEF	Build one real Claude Project: a 150+ word system prompt (who Claude is, the domain to assume, the default output format, what to never do), at least one Skill attached, one knowledge document uploaded, and one Connector enabled. Then run 3 real tasks through it — no tab-switching, no copy-paste.
SUBMIT AS	A Claude Artifact — Project Setup Summary: system prompt + skill rules + connector used + 3 task results. Portfolio asset #2.
TIME	75 minutes
TOOLS	Claude Projects · Skills · Connectors · Claude Artifacts
FEEDS INTO	Feeds into Session 3 — this workspace is what your Schedules, Routines and automations will run on top of.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE `Sidebar → Projects → your workspace`

Everything you built this session lives here. Your system prompt goes in the Project instructions, your Skill attaches to it, your knowledge doc uploads into it, and your Connector switches on for it. Save the setup summary as an **Artifact** — portfolio asset #2.

SESSION 2 OUTCOME

THE SYSTEM IS LIVE.

Skills that shape Claude, Connectors that feed it your data, a Project that remembers, a research pipeline that outthinks any single tool, and a creative set you directed.

You have stopped chatting. You are working with Claude now.

Chatting with AI → Working with AI

NEXT · SESSION 3

Your workspace is built. Session 3 makes it **run on its own** — Claude Schedules and Routines, working with data, and knowing when to reach for external automation like Zapier and n8n.

menler

Your turning point in the AI era.